Preface and acknowledgements

The origins of this book go back to the spring of 1998. When the publishers asked if we would like to consider writing on HACCP, the last thing we wanted to do was another 'how to' book. Both of us had already been involved with publications on the principles of HACCP systems and how organisations could turn those principles into practice. Something different and more useful was needed. A logical progression was a title which explored what had happened to those organisations which had followed the various 'how to' guides. What was it like to translate the theory into practice and to implement a real HACCP system? This idea also fitted in with the wider development of HACCP at that time. By the late 1990s many larger food manufacturers in developed countries in particular had established HACCP systems. There was a fund of experience which might be invaluable for those organisations around the world yet to start HACCP implementation for themselves. At the same time those closest to the subject were starting to reflect on the experience of the pioneers and ask what lessons could be learnt for the future of HACCP. What was needed was a book which brought together HACCP practitioners and asked them to describe and reflect on their experiences. Such a book would need to be an edited collection, drawing in both those from large and small enterprises as well as those responsible for regulation and enforcement. It also needed to be international in its scope. *Making the most of HACCP* was born.

The success of this book depends on the quality of the individual contributors. We deliberately selected those with the most direct experience of HACCP implementation. By definition this meant approaching some of the busiest people in their respective organisations and asking them to describe in detail their experience of HACCP, bad as well as good, essentially for the benefit of others. We are most grateful to the contributors for the considerable

time and thought they have put into the book and for their skill and candour in describing what it was really like translating theory into practice. Everyone concerned with HACCP systems owes them a debt of gratitude. By sharing their experiences so generously, all those wishing to implement HACCP systems for themselves, those thinking about what to do next, and all of us looking for ways to improve the effectiveness of HACCP, have benefited enermously. We are also grateful to the publishers for their patience and support in bringing the collection to fruition and in particular to Francis Dodds for his sterling work in drawing all the chapters together.

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